## Natural gas

| Rank | Country | Production (Metric. Ton) | Share (%) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | United States | 755,010 | 20.56 |
| 2 | Russia | 641,000 | 17.45 |
| 3 | Iran | 202,440 | 5.51 |
| 4 | Qatar | 181,250 | 4.94 |
| 5 | Canada | 157,179 | 4.28 |
| | Other | | 47.26 |

## Trade

Russia, Qatar, Norway, Canada and Algeria are the leading exporters of Natural gas in the world. Japan, Germany, China, Italy and Turkey are the leading importers of natural gas.

## Nuclear Energy

It is commonly said, this energy holds the key of future. Energy contained within the nucleus of an atom is called nuclear energy. Heavy metals like Uranium, Thorium, Radium, Plutonium and Lithium are the main sources of nuclear energy. However Uranium is the most important source of nuclear energy. The nuclear energy production was started first in USA in 1950. Nuclear energy now provides about 11% of the World's electricity. At present there are more than 450 operable fission reactors in the world. The world's first commercial nuclear power station Calder Hall at Wind scale, England was opened in 1956.

**Uranium ($U_3O_8$)**

| Rank | Country | Production (Metric. Ton) | Share (%) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kazakhstan | 29,113 | 38.89 |
| 2 | Canada | 16,666 | 22.26 |
| 3 | Australia | 7,352 | 9.82 |
| 4 | Namibia | 4,308 | 5.75 |
| 5 | Niger | 4,101 | 5.48 |
| | Others | | 17.80 |




Most devastating nuclear accidents

1. Three mile Island- March 28, 1979 USA
2. Chernobyl - April 29,1986,Russia
3. Fukushima Daiich- March 11,2011,Japan

## Renewable sources of Energy:

All regions of the world are facing the twin problems of fast increasing demand for energy and limited supplies and rapidly depleting conventional sources of energy. Under these circumstances, non conventional sources of energy are getting more importance. These sources are renewable, clean and non-polluting. They are solar, wind, geothermal, wave, tidal energy, bio-gas etc.

## Hydel Power

Hydro electricity is produced by using the potential energy of water falling from a certain height. The falling water spins the turbine blades and energy is produced. It is a clean eco friendly and renewable source of energy. It contributes nearly 7% of the world electricity production. China has the largest potential followed by Brazil, Indonesia, Canada and Zaire. China is the largest producer of Hydro electricity in the world, followed by Canada.

## Solar energy

It is based on mechanical conversion of solar energy into electricity. It is available in abundance but only in the recent period it gets more importance due to technological development. Solar energy is used for various purposes.




Noor Complex is the world's largest concentrated solar power (CSP) plant, located in the Sahara Desert.



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